SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #6 · RACE, ETHNICITY AND LANGUAGE

“People like me will never be treated fairly.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

For many, unfair treatment is not a theory: it is experience, from jokes, suspicion, being passed over, or worse. Family stories of injustice add weight. After enough hurts, “never” can feel like realism. This belief deserves to be handled with respect, because injustice is real.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does not minimize injustice. God says, “Learn to do right; seek justice and correct the oppressor.” The psalmist writes, “You have heard, O LORD, the desire of the humble… You will incline Your ear, to vindicate the fatherless and oppressed.” Hagar, a mistreated outsider, called God “the God who sees me.” Amos cries, “Let justice roll on like a river.” God sees, hears, and will judge justly, and He calls His people to act. The word “never” goes beyond what is true: God’s justice is coming, and good people in every community work for it.

> *“You have heard, O LORD, the desire of the humble; You will strengthen their hearts. You will incline Your ear, to vindicate the fatherless and oppressed, that the men of the earth may strike terror no more”* (Psalm 10:17–18).

Also see

> “So Hagar gave this name to the LORD who had spoken to her: ‘You are the God who sees me,’ for she said, ‘Here I have seen the One who sees me!’” (Genesis 16:13).

> “Learn to do right; seek justice and correct the oppressor. Defend the fatherless and plead the case of the widow” (Isaiah 1:17).

> “But let justice roll on like a river, and righteousness like an ever-flowing stream” (Amos 5:24).

> “He has shown you, O man, what is good. And what does the LORD require of you but to act justly, to love mercy, and to walk humbly with your God?” (Micah 6:8).

Common self-statements

- The system is rigged against people like me.
- No matter what I do, I will be judged first by my background.
- Fairness is not for us.
- There is no point in trying.
- They will never see us as equal.
- Things will never change.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that unfairness will always win.
- Overgeneralizing: Assuming everyone will treat me unfairly.
- Catastrophizing: Imagining no good outcomes at all.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling hurt and concluding that hope is foolish.

Challenging questions

- What real experiences of unfairness have I had, and how have they affected me?
- Where have I also been treated with respect or fairness?
- What does God say about justice and the oppressed?
- What can I do, even in small ways, to seek justice or support others?
- Who around me offers solidarity or understanding?
- How can I stay hopeful without denying the pain?

Truth summary

> Injustice is real, and God sees it. He hears the humble and promises justice. I can grieve, speak up where I can, and work with others for fairness, without letting "never" take away my hope.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Persecution
- Hopeless
- Prejudice
- God, All Loving
- Suffering

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Suffering
- Trouble/Hardship

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Greater — MercyMe
God's presence and grace challenge shame and the need to win everyone's approval.

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People like me will never be treated fairly"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People like me will never be treated fairly." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What unfair experiences have I had?
- ☐ Where was I treated fairly?
- ☐ What does God say about justice?
- ☐ What can I do?
- ☐ Who understands?
- ☐ How can I stay hopeful?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God sees me.
- ☐ God hears the humble.
- ☐ God commands justice.
- ☐ Injustice is real and not the last word.
- ☐ I am not alone.
- ☐ I can hope and act.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 10:17–18**
  "You have heard, O LORD, the desire of the humble; You will strengthen their hearts. You will incline Your ear, to vindicate the fatherless and oppressed, that the men of the earth may strike terror no more."
- ☐ **Genesis 16:13**
  "So Hagar gave this name to the LORD who had spoken to her: 'You are the God who sees me,' for she said, 'Here I have seen the One who sees me!'"
- ☐ **Micah 6:8**
  "He has shown you, O man, what is good. And what does the LORD require of you but to act justly, to love mercy, and to walk humbly with your God?"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Seen and heard: Each week, note one way you were treated fairly and one way you spoke up or supported someone.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Psalm 10:17–18 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God sees me and hears the humble.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Prejudice" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Name the hurts. Write the experiences honestly with a trusted friend or counselor.
- ☐ Find community. Connect with others who understand.
- ☐ Take one action. Support a cause, speak up kindly, or mentor someone.
- ☐ Pray Psalm 10:17–18. Bring your grief and your hope to God.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People like me will never be treated fairly": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Hope and action
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People like me will never be treated fairly.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

God who sees, You know every unfair word and act. Hear the cry of the humble, bring justice, and give me courage and hope. Use me to bring Your fairness where I can. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #7 · RACE, ETHNICITY AND LANGUAGE

“People like me don't succeed.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

If we see few examples of people from our background in leadership, college, or business, we may conclude that success is for others. Counselors, teachers, or relatives may have lowered expectations, and the statistics we hear can feel like a sentence.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is full of unlikely people chosen by God: Joseph the slave, Ruth the foreigner, Esther the orphan, David the youngest son. Paul writes, “God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong.” He also says, “I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength.” Group statistics describe averages, not individuals. Your future is not determined by where people like you have been.

> *“But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong”* (1 Corinthians 1:27).

Also see

> “I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength” (Philippians 4:13).

> “Do you see a man skilled in his work? He will be stationed in the presence of kings; he will not stand before obscure men” (Proverbs 22:29).

> “For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope” (Jeremiah 29:11).

> “I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:14).

Common self-statements

- Nobody from my background makes it.
- I will hit a ceiling.
- I do not look like the people who succeed.
- Trying is a waste.
- They will not give me a chance.
- I should not expect much.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Treating group averages as personal destiny.
- Fortune telling: Predicting failure.
- Mental filter: Noticing the failures and missing the successes.
- Labeling: Letting a category define me.

Challenging questions

- Who from my background has succeeded, in any field?
- Who told me people like me do not succeed?

- What strengths and experiences do I bring that others lack?
- What barriers are real, and what can I do about them?
- What does God say about the people He chooses?
- What is one concrete next step?

Truth summary

> Group statistics do not decide my future. God often chooses the unlikely, and He gives strength for the road. Real barriers exist, and I can face them with preparation, allies, and perseverance.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Faith
- Will of God
- Hopeless
- Strength

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Unemployment

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Greater — MercyMe
God's presence and grace challenge shame and the need to win everyone's approval.

More Than Conquerors — Steven Curtis Chapman
Christ's saving work answers condemnation, shame, and fear of separation from God.

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People like me don't succeed"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People like me don't succeed." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who from my background has succeeded?
- ☐ Who told me I cannot?
- ☐ What strengths do I have?
- ☐ What barriers are real?
- ☐ Who can help?
- ☐ What is my next step?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God chooses the unlikely.
- ☐ I can do all things through Christ.
- ☐ Skilled work stands out.
- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ Barriers are real and can be faced.
- ☐ My future is not decided by averages.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 Corinthians 1:27
  "But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong."
- ☐ Philippians 4:13
  "I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength."
- ☐ Psalm 139:14
  "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Evidence of possibility: Each week, add one example of someone like you who succeeded.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 Corinthians 1:27 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God chooses the unlikely, and I can do all things through Christ.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Collect examples. Find three people from your background who succeeded.
- [ ] Find a mentor. Ask someone further down the road to talk.
- [ ] Name a goal. Write one specific goal and the next step.
- [ ] Name barriers and allies. List what stands in the way and who can help.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People like me don't succeed": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Possibility seen
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People like me don't succeed.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You choose the unlikely. Lift my eyes beyond what I have been told. Give me strength, doors, and allies, and use my story for Your glory. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #8 · RACE, ETHNICITY AND LANGUAGE

“Because of my background, I'll always be an outsider.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Accent, skin color, immigration history, religion, or a different way of speaking or eating can set us apart. Repeated questions like “Where are you really from?” or being left out of social circles reinforce a sense of not belonging. We may start to pull back before others can exclude us.

What Scripture teaches

Paul writes, “There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus,” and “You are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of God’s household.” John saw “a multitude too large to count, from every nation and tribe and people and tongue, standing before the throne.” Ruth, a foreigner, said, “Your people will be my people, and your God will be my God,” and was welcomed into Israel’s story. In Christ, background becomes a gift in a family that includes every nation, not a barrier.

> *“Therefore you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of God’s household”* (Ephesians 2:19).

Also see

> “There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus” (Galatians 3:28).

> “After this I looked and saw a multitude too large to count, from every nation and tribe and people and tongue, standing before the throne and before the Lamb. They were wearing white robes and holding palm branches in their hands” (Revelation 7:9).

> “But Ruth replied: ‘Do not urge me to leave you or to turn from following you. For wherever you go, I will go, and wherever you live, I will live; your people will be my people, and your God will be my God.’” (Ruth 1:16).

> “God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land” (Psalm 68:6).

Common self-statements

- I will never fully belong here.
- They will always see me as different.
- I am too foreign.
- There is nowhere I fit.
- I have to hide where I am from.
- Others have a place and I do not.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting permanent exclusion.
- Overgeneralizing: Treating some rejections as universal.
- Labeling: Calling myself “an outsider.”
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling excluded and concluding that I always will be.

Challenging questions

- When have I felt welcomed, even for a moment?
- What would belonging, not sameness, look like for me?
- What do I bring from my background that enriches others?
- What does Scripture say about every nation worshiping together?
- Where might I find communities that welcome people from many backgrounds?
- What is one step toward connection?

Truth summary

> In Christ I belong to a family that includes every nation and tongue. My background is part of who I am, not a reason to be excluded. I can seek welcoming communities and share what I bring.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Prejudice
- Loneliness
- Church
- Friendship
- Citizenship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Softly and Tenderly — Kristyn Getty with Vince Gill, Ellie Holcomb and Sierra Hull
This older hymn pictures Christ's gracious invitation to return rather than hide in shame.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Because of my background, I'll always be an outsider"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Because of my background, I'll always be an outsider." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ When did I feel welcome?
- ☐ What do I bring?
- ☐ What does belonging look like?
- ☐ Where can I find welcome?
- ☐ Whom can I welcome?
- ☐ What is my next step?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am a fellow citizen and member of God's household.
- ☐ There is one family in Christ.
- ☐ Every nation will stand before the throne.
- ☐ My background is a gift.
- ☐ God settles the lonely in families.
- ☐ I can seek and build belonging.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Ephesians 2:19
  "Therefore you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of God's household."
- ☐ Galatians 3:28
  "There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ Revelation 7:9
  "After this I looked and saw a multitude too large to count, from every nation and tribe and people and tongue, standing before the throne and before the Lamb. They were wearing white robes and holding palm branches in their hands."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ A welcome received: Each week, note one welcome you received or offered.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Ephesians 2:19 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am a fellow citizen and a member of God's household.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Prejudice" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Name the moments. Write when you felt excluded and when you felt welcome.
- ☐ Share your story. Tell someone about your culture or background.
- ☐ Find a welcoming group. Visit a church or group with diverse members.
- ☐ Welcome someone else. Invite a newcomer.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Because of my background, I'll always be an outsider": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A welcome
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Because of my background, I'll always be an outsider.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You gather people from every nation. Make me at home in Your family, heal the sting of being excluded, and let me welcome others. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #9 · RACE, ETHNICITY AND LANGUAGE

“Everyone from that group is the same.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Stereotypes are learned early: from family jokes, news coverage, a bad experience, or a neighborhood’s attitudes. Our minds sort people into categories to save effort, and fear or hurt can harden those categories. The result is judging individuals by a label.

What Scripture teaches

God told Samuel, “Man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart,” and Peter learned that God shows no favoritism. James writes, “do not show favoritism.” Genesis teaches, “God created man in His own image… male and female He created them.” Jesus welcomed a Samaritan woman and held up a Samaritan as the hero of a story; the Samaritan “had compassion.” Scripture insists that every person is an individual made in God’s image. Labels flatten what God made unique.

> *“My brothers, as you hold out your faith in our glorious Lord Jesus Christ, do not show favoritism”* (James 2:1).

Also see

> “So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them” (Genesis 1:27).

> “But when a Samaritan on a journey came upon him, he looked at him and had compassion” (Luke 10:33).

> “Here there is no Greek or Jew, circumcised or uncircumcised, barbarian, Scythian, slave, or free, but Christ is all and is in all” (Colossians 3:11).

> “From one man He made every nation of men, that they should inhabit the whole earth; and He determined their appointed times and the boundaries of their lands” (Acts 17:26).

Common self-statements

- They are all alike.
- You can’t trust any of them.
- I know what those people are like.
- One bad experience tells me everything.
- They are all the same.
- I do not need to know them.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Treating one person or experience as representing a group.
- Labeling: Reducing individuals to a category.
- Confirmation bias: Noticing only what fits the stereotype.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know what an individual thinks.

Challenging questions

- Where did I first learn this idea about this group?

- Do I know anyone from this group personally? What are they like?
- Would I want someone to judge me by a label?
- What exceptions have I noticed, and what does that suggest?
- What does it mean that every person is made in God's image?
- How could I get to know one person as an individual?

Truth summary

> Every person is made in God's image and is an individual. Labels hide the person God sees. I can examine my assumptions, listen, and treat people one by one.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Prejudice
- Judgmental
- Love, For Others
- Humility
- Pride

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Judgmental
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Truth Be Told — Matthew West featuring Carly Pearce
Honesty about struggles makes room for grace and support instead of pretending to be fine.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Everyone from that group is the same"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Everyone from that group is the same." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn this?
- ☐ Whom do I know from this group?
- ☐ Would I want a label?
- ☐ What exceptions do I see?
- ☐ What does image of God mean?
- ☐ Whom can I meet?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Every person is made in God's image.
- ☐ God does not show favoritism.
- ☐ Labels hide individuals.
- ☐ Exceptions are not rare, they are the rule.
- ☐ Compassion crosses boundaries.
- ☐ I can listen and learn.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ James 2:1
  "My brothers, as you hold out your faith in our glorious Lord Jesus Christ, do not show favoritism."
- ☐ Genesis 1:27
  "So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them."
- ☐ Luke 10:33
  "But when a Samaritan on a journey came upon him, he looked at him and had compassion."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ One person at a time: Each week, note one assumption you questioned and what you learned.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, James 2:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Every person is made in God's image, so I will not judge by a label.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Prejudice" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Name the stereotype. Write what you think of the group and where it came from.
- ☐ Test it. Look for counterexamples in your own experience.
- ☐ Meet one person. Ask someone from the group about their life.
- ☐ Pray for the group. Pray by name for people you know.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Everyone from that group is the same": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	An assumption questioned
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Everyone from that group is the same.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, forgive me for the ways I have lumped people together. Help me see each person as You see them, made in Your image, and let me love my neighbor with open eyes. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #10 · RACE, ETHNICITY AND LANGUAGE

"I'm less valuable because of where I come from."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Mockery of an accent, a neighborhood, or a country, or being treated as a representative of a stereotype, teaches us that our origin is a defect. Over time, we may apologize for it, hide it, or conclude it makes us less.

What Scripture teaches

"Can anything good come from Nazareth?" Nathanael asked, and Philip answered, "Come and see." Jesus Himself grew up in a despised town. Scripture says, "From one man He made every nation of men," and that God "determined their appointed times and the boundaries of their lands." "The rich and the poor have this in common: The LORD is Maker of them all." We are each "fearfully and wonderfully made." Our place of birth is part of our story, but it is not a measure of our worth.

> *"From one man He made every nation of men, that they should inhabit the whole earth; and He determined their appointed times and the boundaries of their lands"* (Acts 17:26).

Also see

> "'Can anything good come from Nazareth?' Nathanael asked. 'Come and see,' said Philip" (John 1:46).

> "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:14).

> "The rich and the poor have this in common: The LORD is Maker of them all" (Proverbs 22:2).

> "Here there is no Greek or Jew, circumcised or uncircumcised, barbarian, Scythian, slave, or free, but Christ is all and is in all" (Colossians 3:11).

Common self-statements

- Where I come from is a disadvantage.
- I should be ashamed of my background.
- My accent marks me as lesser.
- People from my place are worth less.
- I have to hide my origin.
- I started behind and will stay behind.

Common logical errors

- Labeling: Letting a place define my worth.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling ashamed and concluding that my origin is shameful.
- Mental filter: Focusing on disadvantages and missing strengths.
- Mind reading: Assuming others look down on me.

Challenging questions

- What was good about the place I come from?
- Who taught me to be ashamed, and what did they gain?

- What strengths did I gain from my origin?
- What does Scripture say about nations and places?
- How did Jesus' hometown look to others?
- How might I honor my origin and still grow?

Truth summary

> My worth comes from being made by God, not from my place of birth. My origin shaped me, and it is part of my story. I can tell it with honesty and dignity.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Prejudice
- Guilt/Shame
- Humility
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Judgmental

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Dear Younger Me — MercyMe
Past wounds and choices do not have to become a person's permanent identity.

Hello My Name Is — Matthew West
God's redeemed-child identity challenges labels of regret and defeat.

How Great Thou Art — Jordan Smith
This classic hymn connects God's greatness, Christ's sacrifice, and future hope.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm less valuable because of where I come from"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm less valuable because of where I come from." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What was good about my origin?
- ☐ Who taught me shame?
- ☐ What strengths do I have?
- ☐ What does God say?
- ☐ How can I honor my roots?
- ☐ Who can I tell?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God made every nation from one man.
- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ Good can come from small places.
- ☐ The Lord is Maker of us all.
- ☐ My origin is part of my story.
- ☐ I do not have to hide.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Acts 17:26
  "From one man He made every nation of men, that they should inhabit the whole earth; and He determined their appointed times and the boundaries of their lands."
- ☐ Psalm 139:14
  "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."
- ☐ John 1:46
  "'Can anything good come from Nazareth?' Nathanael asked. 'Come and see,' said Philip."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Roots I honor: Each week, note one strength from your origin.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Acts 17:26 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God made every nation, and my origin is part of His design.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] List what was good. Write five good things about where you come from.
- [ ] Name the shame. Write who taught it and what is false.
- [ ] Share your story. Tell someone about your place.
- [ ] Honor your roots. Cook, visit, or call in a way that honors where you came from.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm less valuable because of where I come from": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A root I honor
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm less valuable because of where I come from.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You made me and placed me in my time and place. Free me from shame about where I come from, and help me honor it with dignity. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.